

PSY405 - Lesson 37

SKINNER'S THEORY OF PERSONALITY

1. Who was Skinner & what is Radical Behaviorism?

B.F. Skinner

Burrhus Frederic Skinner was an **American psychologist** and the **main guy behind Radical Behaviorism**.

Radical Behaviorism (Definition)

Radical Behaviorism is the view that all behavior is shaped and controlled by the environment through reinforcement, and that internal mental states (like anxiety, fear, motives, personality traits) should not be used as explanations for behavior.

Plain English:

Skinner said:

"Stop saying people behave a certain way because of feelings or personality. Look at what happened before and what happened after the behavior."

2. Skinner rejected "inner causes" of behavior

Inner states (Definition)

Inner states = feelings, thoughts, emotions, motives

Examples: anxiety, fear, confidence, anger, heroism

Skinner's BIG disagreement

Most psychologists say:

"You stayed home because you felt anxious."

Skinner says:

| ❌ WRONG explanation.

Example: Party Anxiety (Your example)

Traditional explanation:

You avoid the party **because you feel anxious**.

Skinner's explanation:

You avoid the party **because in the past**, social situations were followed by **unpleasant consequences** (criticism, embarrassment, rejection).

🧠 Anxiety is **not the cause** — it is a **by-product**.

Academic term

- **Aversive contingencies:** situations where behavior is followed by unpleasant outcomes.

📌 Key idea:

The environment trains you. Feelings are just the *side effects*, not the drivers.

Example: Heroism (Fire rescue)

Common belief:

"You ran into the fire because you're brave and heroic."

Skinner's view:

You did it because **similar helping behaviors in the past were reinforced** (praise, respect, self-satisfaction).

📌 Even "heroism" is learned behavior.

3. What is Behaviorism?

Behaviorism (Definition)

A school of psychology that studies **observable behavior only** and explains behavior as a result of **learning**.

Key assumptions:

- All behavior is **learned**
- Behavior is **observable and measurable**
- Behavior = **Stimulus → Response**

Overt vs Covert behavior

- **Overt behavior**: visible actions (talking, walking, studying)
 - **Covert behavior**: thoughts, feelings (ignored by Skinner)
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4. Two types of learning in Behaviorism

A. Classical (Respondent) Conditioning

Definition:

Learning through **association between two stimuli**.

 Developed by **Pavlov**, not Skinner.

Example:

Dog hears bell → food → salivation

Eventually: bell → salivation

B. Operant (Instrumental) Conditioning

Definition:

Learning where **behavior is shaped by its consequences** (reward or punishment).

 This is **Skinner's main work**.

Formula:

Behavior → Consequence → Future behavior changes

5. Reinforcement: the heart of Skinner's theory

Reinforcement (Definition)

Anything that **increases the frequency** of a behavior.

⚠ Important:

Reinforcement is defined by its **effect**, not by intention.

6. Types of Reinforcement (VERY IMPORTANT)

1. Positive Reinforcement

Definition:

A behavior increases because it is **followed by a reward**.

📌 "Positive" = something is **added**

Examples:

- Student studies → gets A → studies more
 - Rat presses lever → gets food → presses more
 - Child asks politely → gets candy → asks more
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2. Negative Reinforcement (MOST CONFUSING)

Definition:

A behavior increases because it **removes or reduces something unpleasant**.

📌 "Negative" = something is **removed**

📌 Still **increases behavior**

Examples:

- Pull string → electric shock stops → pull string more
- Take rest → headache goes away → rest more
- Seatbelt stops annoying beep → you wear seatbelt more

⚠ Negative reinforcement ≠ punishment

7. Decreasing behavior

A. Extinction

Definition:

Stopping reinforcement → behavior gradually disappears.

Example:

Child asks for candy → no candy → asking decreases

📌 Behavior dies out because it no longer “works”.

B. Punishment

Definition:

A behavior decreases because it is **followed by an aversive stimulus**.

📌 Punishment = adding or removing something to **reduce behavior**

Examples:

- Slap for asking candy
- D grade → no vacations
- Soap in mouth for bad language

Punishing stimulus (Definition)

An **aversive stimulus** that reduces future behavior.

🔥 Reinforcement vs Punishment (Exam GOLD)

Concept	Effect
Reinforcement	Increases behavior
Punishment	Decreases behavior
Negative Reinforcement	Removes pain to increase behavior

Concept	Effect
Punishment	Adds pain or removes pleasure to decrease behavior

8. Generalization & Discrimination

Generalization (Definition)

When learning **spreads** to similar situations.

Examples:

- Praised in psychology → studies other subjects better
- Teacher learns to handle one angry student → handles others better

Discrimination (Definition)

Learning to **respond differently** to different stimuli.

Example:

"You look nice today"

- Said by friend lovingly → feels good
- Said sarcastically by enemy → feels bad

 Same words, different meaning → different response.

9. Schedules of Reinforcement (VERY IMPORTANT)

Schedule of Reinforcement (Definition)

Rules about **when and how often** reinforcement is given.

1. Continuous Reinforcement

Every response is reinforced.

 Fast learning, fast extinction

Example:

Every good grade → reward

2. Interval Schedules (Time-based)

Fixed Interval

Reinforcement after **fixed time**

Example: Salary every month

Variable Interval

Reinforcement after **changing time intervals**

Example: Checking email → sometimes message arrives

 Leads to steady behavior

3. Ratio Schedules (Response-based)

Fixed Ratio

Reward after **fixed number of responses**

Example: Every 10th sale → bonus

Variable Ratio

Reward after **unpredictable number of responses**

Example:



Gambling



Slot machines



Most addictive schedule

10. Treatment Techniques (Applied Skinner)

1. Shaping / Successive Approximations

Definition:

Reinforcing small steps toward final behavior.

Examples:

- Learning to drive
- Teaching disabled child to eat
- Teaching reading step-by-step

📌 Complex behavior = built gradually

2. Systematic Desensitization (Wolpe)

⚠️ Not Skinner, but behaviorist

Used for: phobias & anxiety

Based on: Classical conditioning

Steps:

1. Relaxation
2. Fear hierarchy
3. Gradual exposure

Example: Fear of lizards (pictures → videos → real → touch)

3. Aversive Conditioning

Definition:

Pairing unwanted behavior with unpleasant effects.

Examples:

- Drug + nausea
- Soap for bad language

⚠️ Ethically controversial

4. Assertion Training

Teaching people to say **"No" politely and confidently.**

Used for:

- Shy people
 - People-pleasers
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5. Behavior Modification

Replacing bad behavior with good behavior using reinforcement.

Used for:

- Addiction
 - Autism
 - Schizophrenia
 - Shyness
 - Intellectual disability
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6. Token Economy

Definition:

Rewarding good behavior with tokens exchangeable for real rewards.

Used in:

- Mental hospitals
 - Prisons
 - Special education
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11. Applications of Skinner's theory

- Education (programmed learning, teaching machines)
 - Behavior change
 - Special children
 - Prison reforms
 - Drug addiction treatment
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12. Skinner's View of Personality

Personality (Skinner's definition)

Personality is the sum total of learned behaviors shaped by reinforcement history.

📌 No traits. No inner self. No unconscious.

13. Happiness (Skinner's bold claim)

Happiness = by-product of reinforcement

What makes us happy?

- Health
- Respect
- Money
- Power
- Success

📌 Because these things **reinforce behavior**.

FINAL TAKEAWAY

- Behavior is controlled by **environment**, not feelings
- Change reinforcement → change personality
- Focus on **what people do**, not what they feel
- Skinner = Operant Conditioning king

Short QnAs

1. What is Skinner's Radical Behaviorism?

Answer:

Radical Behaviorism is a school of psychology proposed by B.F. Skinner which emphasizes that all human behavior is learned through interaction with the environment. It rejects explanations of behavior based on internal mental states such as feelings, thoughts, or motives, and focuses only on observable behavior and the reinforcement that shapes it.

Explanation:

Skinner believed that you cannot explain why someone does something by looking at what they feel inside. Instead, you must examine what happened **before** the behavior (stimuli) and **after** the behavior (reinforcement or punishment). Behavior is learned from the environment.

Example:

A child avoids social gatherings not because they are "shy," but because past experiences of embarrassment (aversive outcomes) taught them to avoid these situations.

Tips:

Remember: "Feelings are side effects, behavior is the main story." Focus on **cause-effect in environment**, not inner states.

2. What does Skinner reject in explaining human behavior?

Answer:

Skinner rejects explanations that rely on internal states such as anxiety, fear, heroism, or motivation as causes of behavior. He argues that these inner experiences are **by-products** of environmental contingencies and reinforcements, not the primary cause.

Explanation:

Instead of saying "I stayed home because I felt anxious," Skinner would say "I stayed home because avoiding social gatherings in the past prevented negative outcomes like embarrassment or criticism." Anxiety is just a side effect, not the driver.

Example:

A person rushing into a burning building is not “heroic” because of inner bravery; rather, past experiences or social reinforcement might have shaped similar helping behaviors.

Tips:

Think: “Behavior follows consequences, not feelings.”

3. Define behaviorism.

Answer:

Behaviorism is a psychological approach that studies **observable behavior** rather than internal mental processes. It emphasizes that behavior is learned through interaction with the environment, mainly through the mechanisms of **classical (respondent) and operant (instrumental) conditioning**.

Explanation:

Behaviorism ignores what happens inside the mind because you can’t measure it objectively. Instead, it looks at what people or animals do and how consequences shape their actions.

Example:

Teaching a dog to sit using treats rather than trying to infer what the dog “wants.”

Tips:

Behaviorism = **Learning by environment + observable behavior**. Forget traits and feelings for this theory.

4. What is operant conditioning?

Answer:

Operant conditioning is a type of learning in which behavior is influenced by its consequences. A behavior that is followed by a positive outcome or removal of an unpleasant outcome is more likely to occur in the future.

Explanation:

Skinner focused on **consequences shaping behavior**. The key is the **reinforcement** (increases behavior) or **punishment** (decreases behavior) after the

action. This is different from classical conditioning, which is about associating stimuli.

Example:

- Rat presses lever → gets food (positive reinforcement) → presses lever more.
- Child wears seatbelt → annoying beep stops (negative reinforcement) → wears seatbelt more.

Tips:

Think: **"Do something → outcome changes frequency of doing it again."**

5. Define positive reinforcement. Give examples.

Answer:

Positive reinforcement occurs when a behavior increases because it is followed by a **reward or pleasant stimulus**.

Explanation:

"Positive" means **adding something**, and reinforcement means **increasing behavior**. It makes the individual more likely to repeat the behavior.

Examples:

- Student studies hard → gets A → studies hard for next test.
- Child asks politely for candy → receives candy → asks more politely.

Tips:

Mnemonic: **Positive = Add, Reinforcement = Increase behavior**.

6. Define negative reinforcement. Give examples.

Answer:

Negative reinforcement occurs when a behavior increases because it **removes or reduces an unpleasant stimulus**.

Explanation:

"Negative" = something unpleasant is **taken away**, and the behavior is **strengthened** as a result. Unlike punishment, it increases behavior rather than

decreasing it.

Examples:

- Pull lever → electric shock stops → lever-pulling increases.
- Take rest → headache goes away → rest more.
- Wear seatbelt → car's alarm stops → wear seatbelt regularly.

Tips:

Key point: **Negative reinforcement increases behavior** (not to be confused with punishment).

7. What is punishment? Give examples.

Answer:

Punishment is a process in which a behavior decreases because it is followed by an **aversive stimulus** or removal of a positive stimulus.

Explanation:

Punishment = **adding discomfort or removing reward** to reduce future behavior. Unlike reinforcement, it decreases behavior.

Examples:

- Child speaks rudely → given soap in mouth.
- Student gets D grade → summer school and no vacation.

Tips:

Remember: **Punishment = Reduce behavior. Reinforcement = Increase behavior.**

8. What is extinction? Give examples.

Answer:

Extinction is the gradual **disappearance of a behavior** when reinforcement is no longer provided.

Explanation:

If a behavior is no longer rewarded or reinforced, it stops over time.

Examples:

- Child asks for candy → candy no longer given → asking declines.
- Dog sits → no longer gets treat → stops sitting on command.

Tips:

Extinction is like “natural dying” of a learned behavior. Reinforcement keeps it alive.

9. Define generalization and discrimination with examples.**Answer:**

- **Generalization:** When a behavior learned in one situation spreads to similar situations.
- **Discrimination:** When an individual learns to **respond differently** to different stimuli.

Explanation:

- Generalization: Learning one behavior applies elsewhere.
- Discrimination: Learning to react only to specific signals, ignoring others.

Examples:

- Generalization: Child praised in psychology → studies other subjects better.
- Discrimination: “You look nice today” → friendly tone = feel good, sarcastic tone = feel bad.

Tips:

Mnemonic: **Generalization = “spread”, Discrimination = “distinguish”.**

10. Explain schedules of reinforcement.**Answer:**

Schedules of reinforcement are **rules for how and when reinforcement is given**. They influence **how fast behavior is learned** and **how long it lasts**.

Explanation:

Skinner found different patterns of reinforcement change behavior rate and resistance to extinction.

Types & Examples:

Type	Definition	Example
Continuous	Every correct response is reinforced	Every test A → reward
Fixed Interval	Reinforcement after fixed time	Salary every month
Variable Interval	Reinforcement after changing time	Checking email randomly
Fixed Ratio	Reinforcement after fixed number of responses	Bonus every 10 sales
Variable Ratio	Reinforcement after varying number of responses	Gambling, slot machines

Tips:

Variable schedules = most addictive. Continuous = fastest learning but fast extinction.

11. What is shaping (successive approximations)? Give example.

Answer:

Shaping is a technique where **successive small steps toward a target behavior** are reinforced until the final behavior is achieved.

Explanation:

Complex behaviors are taught gradually. Early approximations are rewarded to encourage progress.

Examples:

- Teaching a child to read → letters → sounds → words → sentences.
- Learning to drive → pressing pedals → steering → full driving.

Tips:

Think: **"Baby steps + reward = complex skill."**

12. Explain token economy.

Answer:

Token economy is a system in which desirable behaviors are reinforced with tokens that can later be exchanged for rewards.

Explanation:

Used in institutions (prisons, mental hospitals, special schools) to **shape positive behavior**. Both reinforcement and removal of tokens guide behavior.

Examples:

- Patient follows routine → gets token → can exchange for candy or privileges.
- Child makes bed → gets sticker → collects for small prize.

Tips:

Token economy = **behavior currency**.

13. What is behavior modification?

Answer:

Behavior modification is a method of **replacing undesirable behaviors with desirable ones** using reinforcement principles.

Explanation:

This approach uses operant conditioning to change habits, improve social skills, treat autism, addiction, or shyness.

Examples:

- Replace smoking with exercise using positive reinforcement.
- Timid child encouraged to speak in class with praise.

Tips:

Behavior modification = **planned reinforcement to shape personality**.

14. How does Skinner view personality?

Answer:

Skinner views personality as the **sum of learned behaviors**, shaped by the history of reinforcement and interaction with the environment, rather than internal traits or motives.

Explanation:

Personality is **not inside your head**; it's what you consistently do, influenced by reinforcement.

Example:

- A helpful person → reinforced by praise and gratitude → continues helping.
- A punctual person → reinforced by respect and privileges → maintains punctuality.

Tips:

Think: "**Personality = behavior history.**"

Lesson 37 – SKINNER'S THEORY OF PERSONALITY

1. Explain Skinner's Radical Behaviorism and its key principles.

Answer:

Definition:

Radical Behaviorism is B.F. Skinner's psychological theory which emphasizes that all human behavior is shaped by environmental contingencies, through reinforcement and punishment. Internal states like thoughts, feelings, and motives are **not valid explanations** for behavior, though they may occur as by-products.

Key Principles:

1. Behavior is learned:

- All actions result from interaction with the environment.
- Past reinforcement history shapes future behavior.

2. Observable behavior is central:

- Focus is only on **overt, measurable behavior**, not internal mental processes.

3. Reinforcement determines behavior:

- Behaviors followed by positive or negative reinforcement are **more likely** to recur.
- Punishment decreases behavior frequency.

4. Personality is learned:

- Personality = sum total of learned behaviors.
- It is not traits, feelings, or inner drives.

5. Behavior is predictable:

- Given similar environmental contingencies, behavior can be predicted and modified.

Examples:

Situation	Traditional Explanation	Skinnerian Explanation
Avoids social gatherings	"Shy or anxious"	Past social situations were unpleasant (negative reinforcement)
Runs into burning building	"Heroic, brave"	Past behavior reinforced by social praise or self-satisfaction

Plain English Explanation:

Skinner basically said, "Stop blaming feelings or traits for behavior. Look at what happens **before and after the action.**"

If something makes you happy, keeps you safe, or avoids discomfort, your behavior will continue. Personality is **just patterns of learned behaviors** over time. So your "heroism," "shyness," or "anxiety" are not causes—they're just the side effects of learning.

2. Describe operant conditioning and its types of reinforcement.

Answer:

Definition:

Operant conditioning is a learning process where the **frequency of behavior changes** depending on its consequences.

Key Elements:

1. Reinforcement (Increase Behavior):

- **Positive Reinforcement:** Adding a pleasant stimulus → increases behavior
- **Negative Reinforcement:** Removing an unpleasant stimulus → increases behavior

2. Punishment (Decrease Behavior):

- **Positive Punishment:** Adding an aversive stimulus → decreases behavior
- **Negative Punishment:** Removing a pleasant stimulus → decreases behavior

3. Extinction:

- Stopping reinforcement → behavior gradually disappears

Examples:

Type	Definition	Example
Positive Reinforcement	Add reward to increase behavior	Child studies → gets candy → studies more
Negative Reinforcement	Remove unpleasant thing to increase behavior	Seatbelt alarm stops → wears seatbelt
Positive Punishment	Add unpleasant thing to decrease behavior	Slap for misbehavior
Negative Punishment	Remove pleasant thing to decrease behavior	No TV for bad grades
Extinction	Stop reward → decrease behavior	Stop giving candy → asking stops

Plain English Explanation:

Operant conditioning is like **life's feedback system**. Behave in a way that leads to something good → do it more. Behave in a way that leads to something bad → do

it less. Reinforcement = encourages, Punishment = discourages. Extinction = forgetting behavior because it no longer "pays off."

3. Explain the difference between classical and operant conditioning.

Answer:

Feature	Classical Conditioning	Operant Conditioning
Focus	Association between stimuli	Association between behavior and consequences
Main Concept	Stimulus → Response	Behavior → Consequence
Key Figures	Pavlov, Watson	Thorndike, Skinner
Role of Learner	Passive (responds automatically)	Active (emits behavior)
Example	Dog salivates to bell	Rat presses lever for food

Example:

- **Classical:** Bell → Food → Salivation → Bell alone → Salivation
 - **Operant:** Press lever → Food → Press lever more
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Plain English Explanation:

Classical conditioning = "you react automatically to signals."

Operant conditioning = "you act, get feedback, and adjust future actions."

Think: Classical = reflex; Operant = learning from consequences.

4. What are schedules of reinforcement? Explain with examples.

Answer:

Definition:

Schedules of reinforcement are **rules for when and how reinforcement is given**, which affects **learning speed, behavior persistence, and extinction**.

Types:

1. Continuous Reinforcement:

- Every correct response is rewarded
- Fast learning, fast extinction
- Example: Every A → reward

2. Interval Schedules:

- Based on **time intervals**
- Fixed Interval: Reward after same interval → Salary every month
- Variable Interval: Reward after random intervals → Checking emails

3. Ratio Schedules:

- Based on **number of responses**
- Fixed Ratio: Reward every fixed number of actions → Bonus every 10 sales
- Variable Ratio: Reward after varying number of actions → Gambling, slot machines

Plain English Explanation:

Schedules = "rules for giving rewards." Some are predictable, some are random.

Random schedules = behavior is steady and hard to extinguish (think gambling!).

Fixed schedules = predictable but easier to stop when rewards stop.

5. Discuss methods of treatment based on operant conditioning.

Answer:

1. Shaping (Successive Approximations):

- Reinforce small steps toward a final behavior.
- Used for complex skills or teaching disabled children.

Example:

- Learning to read: letters → sounds → words → sentences
- Teaching patient participation in therapy: approaching room → entering → participating

2. Token Economy:

- Reward desirable behavior with tokens that can be exchanged for real rewards.
- Used in institutions like prisons, mental hospitals, or special schools.

3. Behavior Modification:

- Replace undesirable behavior with desirable ones using reinforcement.
- Useful for addiction, shyness, autism, or problematic behaviors.

4. Assertion Training:

- Teach individuals to **say no politely** to unreasonable demands.

5. Aversive Conditioning:

- Pair unwanted behavior with unpleasant stimulus to reduce it.
- Example: Soap in mouth for bad language; drugs paired with nausea

6. Systematic Desensitization (Wolpe):

- Relaxation + gradual exposure to fear-inducing stimulus (based on classical conditioning).
- Example: Treating phobia of lizards: picture → video → touch → hold

Plain English Explanation:

Treatments = **practical applications of reinforcement/punishment principles.**

- Shaping = small steps rewarded
- Token economy = behavior currency
- Behavior modification = swap bad habits for good ones
- Aversive conditioning = unpleasant consequence stops behavior
- Systematic desensitization = gradually reduce fear

6. How does Skinner explain personality development?

Answer:

Key Points:

- Personality = sum of **learned behaviors**, shaped by **history of reinforcement**.
- Internal traits, motives, or feelings do **not cause personality**.
- Happiness and satisfaction are **by-products** of reinforced behaviors.
- Personality can be **changed by altering reinforcement contingencies**.

Examples:

- Helpful person → praised → continues helping
- Punctual person → rewarded → maintains habit
- Shy child → gradually reinforced for speaking → becomes confident

Plain English Explanation:

For Skinner, “who you are” is basically the pattern of all your learned behaviors. If you want to change personality, **change the reinforcement**. Feeling good is just the bonus from behaviors that have been positively reinforced.

7. Applications of Skinner’s theory in real life

Answer:

1. Education:

- Programmed learning, teaching machines, positive reinforcement for learning

2. Behavior Change:

- Encouraging desired habits (studying, punctuality, social skills)

3. Special Education:

- Teaching mentally retarded or autistic children via shaping and reinforcement

4. Prison Reform:

- Use of token economy to promote good behavior

5. Addiction Treatment:

- Behavior modification to reduce substance abuse

6. Therapy for Phobias/Anxiety:

- Systematic desensitization for fear management

Plain English Explanation:

Skinner's ideas are everywhere: classrooms, therapy, hospitals, prisons. Basically, anywhere **behavior needs to be learned, changed, or managed**, his methods can be applied.

CHEAT SHEET

1. Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Example	Tip / Mnemonic
Radical Behaviorism	All behavior shaped by environment; internal states are not causes	Avoiding party = due to past negative experiences, not anxiety	"Behavior is learned, feelings are side effects"
Reinforcement	Anything that increases behavior	Praise for good grades → study more	Remember: Reinforce = Increase
Punishment	Anything that decreases behavior	Slap for bad behavior → behavior decreases	Punishment = Reduce
Positive Reinforcement	Add something pleasant to increase behavior	Candy for asking politely	Positive = Add, Reinforce = Increase
Negative Reinforcement	Remove something unpleasant to increase behavior	Seatbelt alarm stops → wear seatbelt	Negative = Remove pain → behavior ↑
Positive Punishment	Add something unpleasant to decrease behavior	Soap in mouth for bad language	Positive = Add → behavior ↓
Negative Punishment	Remove something pleasant to decrease	No TV for bad grades	Negative = Remove → behavior ↓

Term	Definition	Example	Tip / Mnemonic
	behavior		
Extinction	Behavior disappears when reinforcement stops	Stop giving candy → child stops asking	Extinction = Stop reward → behavior dies
Generalization	Learned behavior spreads to similar situations	Praise for psychology → better performance in other subjects	Generalization = Spread
Discrimination	Learning to respond differently to different stimuli	"You look nice" → friendly vs sarcastic tone	Discrimination = Distinguish
Operant Conditioning	Behavior shaped by consequences	Rat presses lever → gets food	Behavior → Consequence → Future behavior
Classical Conditioning	Behavior learned through stimulus association	Pavlov: Bell → Salivation	Classical = Reflex/automatic
Shaping / Successive Approximations	Reinforcing small steps toward a final behavior	Teach reading: letters → words → sentences	Baby steps + reward = complex skill
Token Economy	Desirable behavior rewarded with tokens exchangeable for prizes	Hospital: Tokens → candy or privileges	Token = Behavior currency
Behavior Modification	Replace undesirable behavior with desirable one using reinforcement	Reduce smoking by rewarding exercise	Swap bad habits with good ones
Systematic Desensitization	Gradual exposure to fear while relaxed (phobias)	Fear of lizards: pictures → videos → touch	Relax → Gradual exposure

2. Core Principles

1. **All behavior is learned** from environment (not inner states).

2. **Observable behavior is central**; ignore thoughts/feelings.
3. **Personality = sum of learned behaviors**.
4. **Reinforcement shapes behavior**, punishment decreases it.
5. **Schedules of reinforcement** affect learning speed and extinction.

3. Reinforcement vs Punishment – Quick Table

Concept	Adds / Removes	Effect on behavior	Example
Positive Reinforcement	Adds pleasant	Increases	Candy for studying
Negative Reinforcement	Removes unpleasant	Increases	Seatbelt alarm stops → wear seatbelt
Positive Punishment	Adds unpleasant	Decreases	Soap for bad language
Negative Punishment	Removes pleasant	Decreases	No TV for bad grades

Memory Tip:

- **Reinforcement** → **up arrow** (behavior ↑)
- **Punishment** → **down arrow** (behavior ↓)
- **Positive** = **add something**
- **Negative** = **remove something**

4. Schedules of Reinforcement

Type	How it works	Example	Key Notes
Continuous	Every response reinforced	Every A → candy	Fast learning, fast extinction
Fixed Interval	Reward after fixed time	Salary every month	Predictable, behavior rises near reward
Variable Interval	Reward after random time	Checking emails	Steady, hard to extinguish

Type	How it works	Example	Key Notes
Fixed Ratio	Reward after fixed responses	Bonus every 10 sales	High response rate
Variable Ratio	Reward after varying responses	Gambling / slot machines	Most addictive, very resistant to extinction

Tip: Variable = most addictive; Continuous = fast learning but fragile.

5. Applications – Quick Scan

- **Education:** Programmed learning, teaching machines, positive reinforcement
- **Behavior change:** Encourage good habits, reduce bad habits
- **Special education:** Teach autistic/disabled children via shaping
- **Prison reforms:** Token economy, behavior shaping
- **Addiction treatment:** Behavior modification, aversive conditioning
- **Phobia & anxiety therapy:** Systematic desensitization

6. Mnemonics & Memory Hooks

1. **"RIP GENT"** → Reinforcement, Increase, Punishment, Generalization, Extinction, Negative reinforcement, Token economy
2. **Positive vs Negative:**
 - **Positive = add something**
 - **Negative = remove something**
 - Reinforcement = increases behavior
 - Punishment = decreases behavior
3. **Classical vs Operant:**
 - **Classical = Reflex, automatic, Pavlov**
 - **Operant = Action → consequence → learning, Skinner**
4. **Behavior = History of reinforcement:**

- Think: Personality is like a **playlist of your learned behaviors**